



MANDAR DEODHAR/www.indiatodayimages.com

**METRO CONSTRUCTION
IN THE ANDHERI AREA**

Tracks of TRAUMA

Instead of bringing cheer, short-sighted implementation of the metro project turns traffic into a nightmare and chokes the city's sole remaining zone of air and light

| By Nishika Patel |

The resounding success of the Delhi Metro has triggered a race among Indian cities to get a metro they can call their own. India's financial capital too has started off on an ambitious nine-line metro project that has brought parts of Mumbai to a halt. Already, road space has shrunk, footpaths are depleted and huge columns stand in the

middle of busy roads. Architect Nitin Killawala says: "It will be like living in a basement once the metro is complete. Forget gardens—the road is our only open space and a source of ventilation and light. That too is being taken away." Just a small stretch from Colaba to Bandra and from Bandra to the airport will be underground.

Killawala has now filed a public interest litigation, one of many against the metro. It is clear that the state

Government has taken a short-term view by deciding to chalk out an elevated network in a densely packed city. While the Delhi Metro has become a sparkling model for how infrastructure projects should be carried out, Mumbai Metro is heading on the opposite track. Financing, rather than foolproof planning, is driving the Rs 35,000 crore project. The first two lines are being constructed by Mumbai Metro One Pvt Ltd, a consor-